



ence without humanity, potential for commerce without morality, potential for knowledge without character, pleasure without conscience, and then there's the other three that may not directly apply in this particular context. But I think it's crucial that every time we keep raising the bar on what happens with technology, you are at great peril if you ignore humanity.

Second, there is a very interesting book... that says you've got to have a digital mindset now in terms of your leadership skills, but they call it the 30 per cent rule. You don't have to be a real expert to the extent of 100 per cent. But then as you think about that 30 per cent and you think about what does that do in terms of the ability to achieve better coordination, the ability to do better computation, the ability to think about change management, you can already see that there are so many elements coming together.



You have worked with Tata

Administrative Services. When you look at Indian companies, what can they do to become global winners?

I think it is a little bit about naturally trying to appreciate the different ways in which you become more global. By the way, this is true for Japanese companies, too. If you think about it, you can obviously give the counter example of a Toyota or Honda but then I can give you examples of companies like Nippon Steel and others that were at the very top. When the local market is very big, the automatic pressure for you to start going global is not as strong. And to become more global, you end up having to think differently about what the particular context is and that is a little more of a challenge for companies.

In my early years of working with Mr Ratan Tata in India, I remember how inspiring it was for us to think about Jamsetji Tata and the way he set up the organisation and his contributions to society. What is very interesting for me is when I worked with Mr Tata, the problem I was working on at that time, which I didn't quite understand was, 'how do you share risk on the one side and create incentives on the other?' I probably wrote four or five papers in my academic career just based on that problem.



The pandemic has ignited a debate about the future of globalisation. One school of thought pushes localisation and regionalisation fostering resilient supply chains and to go beyond China, creating big opportunity for countries like India. The other is centred in reality—money will go where it makes sense for it to go, which remains China. Which side of the argument do you come from?

There is no question that the current pressures are such that you've

seen the disruption in global supply chains that have occurred and the need for resilience is causing a lot of companies to do much more in terms of trying to think about these alternative supply chains. And that's not just in materials because that's the area that we are most obvious and most familiar with. But if you think about individuals, and the opportunity for them to get the right kind of skills, you see companies like Microsoft and Google already investing heavily in developing talent in reskilling... that's already needed for the new digital world but it's a matter of return on one side, and risk on the other.

I definitely see a trend towards more regionalisation occurring in the short run... There have been significant periods of regionalisation or deglobalisation followed by re-globalisation. I'll give an example of a project we're doing at HBS-OneTen. One stands for 1 million and 10 stands for 10 years. And the goal of the OneTen initiative is to employ these individuals who do not have a college degree in living wage jobs in corporate America over 10 years... Now suddenly, rather than keep looking for people who have their college degrees, you are opening up your talent pool to a large number of individuals who are talented, skilled, motivated, capable, but don't have the credentials of getting that particular job. Well, that's going to change [things] dramatically... This will be fantastic for business and society. And if we can figure out how to select these individuals, train them, develop them inside organisations... we have committed significant resources to figure this out because we think it has major implications for the world and HBS has an opportunity here to do things that will make the world a better place. **BT**

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